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Agenda item 4 (b)
Strategic management, budgetary and administrative questions: directives on policy and budgetary issues for the United Nations crime prevention and criminal justice programme

Consolidated budget for the biennium 2026–2027 for the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime

Report of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions

I. Introduction

1. The Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions has considered an advance version of the report of the Executive Director on the consolidated budget for the biennium 2026–2027 for the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC) (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17). During its consideration of the report, the Advisory Committee received additional information and clarifications, concluding with written responses received on 14 November 2025.

2. The consolidated budget for the biennium 2026–2027 for UNODC reflects resource projections from both voluntary contributions and the regular budget of the United Nations and is submitted, for approval, to the Commission on Narcotic Drugs and the Commission on Crime Prevention and Criminal Justice, pursuant to General Assembly resolutions 46/185 C and 61/252, section XI. The consolidated budget presents information for all four funding sources of UNODC, comprising general-purpose funds, special-purpose funds, programme support costs and the regular budget. As indicated in paragraph 2 of the report of the Executive Director, the budget of the programme of the funds (general-purpose funds) is presented to the Commissions for approval, and the budgets of special-purpose funds and the related administrative and programme support cost budget (programme support cost funds) are presented to the Commissions for endorsement. The financial position of the Fund of the United Nations International Drug Control Programme and the United Nations Crime Prevention and Criminal Justice Fund is set out in the report of the Executive Director (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, annex III).

3. As indicated in the report of the Executive Director, general-purpose funds are unearmarked voluntary contributions that are provided to finance limited core

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programmatic functions not funded by the regular budget, including normative work and research, institutional initiatives and programmatic shortfalls. Special-purpose funds are earmarked voluntary contributions that are provided to finance the Office's technical cooperation and other substantive activities at headquarters (Vienna) and in the field. Programme support costs are the charges collected on voluntary contributions to recover the additional costs incurred in support of programme delivery financed from voluntary contributions. These costs are capped at 13 per cent, in accordance with General Assembly resolution 35/217 and are restricted to indirect support under predetermined categories (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, paras. 3 and 4).

4. The report of the Executive Director indicates that the regular budget resources shown in the consolidated budget for UNODC have been submitted to the General Assembly in sections 16 and 23 of the proposed programme budget for 2026 (A/80/6 (Sect.16) and A/80/6 (Sect.23)), and adjusted in line with the report of the Secretary-General on the revised estimates relating to the proposed programme budget for 2026 and the support account for peacekeeping operations for the 2025/26 period (A/80/400). For presentation purposes, the requirements for 2027 are extrapolated at a similar level to the proposal for 2026, including adjustments for non-recurrent activities (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, para. 5).

II. Financial projections

Income projections

5. As indicated in the report of the Executive Director, the overall income of UNODC is projected to be $707.2 million in the biennium 2026–2027, reflecting a decrease of $191.9 million (or 21.3 per cent) compared with $899.0 million in the biennium 2024–2025. The anticipated decrease is owing to the continuing multiple crises and a highly unstable global financial environment. The anticipated income by source of funding for the biennium 2026–2027 is as follows: (a) general-purpose income: $8.8 million (1.2 per cent of total income), reflecting an increase of $0.8 million (or 10.0 per cent) compared with the revised income for the biennium 2024–2025; (b) special-purpose income: $576.7 million (81.6 per cent of total income) reflecting a decrease of $185.6 million (or 24.3 per cent) compared with the revised income for the biennium 2024–2025; (c) programme support cost income: $69.6 million (9.8 per cent of total income), reflecting a decrease of $5.0 million (or 6.7 per cent) compared with the revised income for the biennium 2024–2025; and (d) regular budget resources: $52.0 million (7.4 per cent of total income), reflecting a decrease of $2.1 million (or 3.9 per cent) compared with the combined budgets approved for the programme budgets of 2024 and 2025 (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, paras. 50–52 and figure I). **The Advisory Committee notes the overall reduced income projections for the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime for the biennium 2026–2027 and trusts that updated information will be provided to the Commissions at the time of consideration of the present report**.

6. With regard to the regular budget, the report indicates that the regular budget resources are anticipated at $52.0 million, on the assumption that the level proposed for 2026, taking into account the revised estimates in line with the UN80 Initiative, will be maintained in 2027, including adjustments for non-recurrent activities. The report also indicates that UNODC work on intergovernmental meetings mandated by treaty or governing bodies and the support provided to Member States relating to the implementation of the new United Nations Convention against Cybercrime are projected to be adversely affected by austerity measures related to the regular budget (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, paras. 44 and 61). With regard to the general-purpose funds, the report indicates that the level of general-purpose funds was set at $9.2 million in the consolidated budget. However, the projected income of $8.8 million in 2026–2027 would not be sufficient for UNODC to manage its operations strategically and respond rapidly to changing and new priorities (ibid., paras. 44 and 58). **The Advisory Committee notes the estimated decrease under**

the regular budget and the projected receipt of insufficient income for general-purpose funds for the biennium 2026–2027, and trusts that the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime will put in place measures to mitigate the impact on its normative and policy mandated work.

7. With regard to the programme support cost income, the Advisory Committee was informed, upon enquiry, that the projected decline in the amount of $5 million directly reflects the anticipated lower programme delivery under special-purpose funds in the biennium 2026–2027. Since programme support cost income is calculated as a percentage of estimated special-purpose fund expenditures, any increase or decrease in programme delivery correspondingly affects the level of programme support cost income.

8. The report of the Executive Director indicates that in 2024, UNODC achieved a record level of pledges, totalling $519 million. In 2023 and 2024, 55 new partners from the public and private sectors and the United Nations system pledged $41 million. However, a comparable level of income has not yet been secured for the upcoming biennium (ibid., para. 35). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was provided with the table below indicating the income contributions to UNODC (earmarked and unearmarked) by type of donor from 2022 through 2026. The Committee was informed that the projected decline in overall income for UNODC in the biennium 2026–2027 was primarily due to reduced contributions to the special-purpose funds, which account for 82 per cent of the total income of UNODC.

Table 1
Contributions to the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime, by donor type, 2022–2023 and 2024–2025 (estimates)
(United States dollars)

Source of contribution	*2022*	*2023*	*2024*	*2025 (Projected)*	*2026 (Projected)*
Contributions from bilateral partners	327 191 000	372 303 467	396 411 061	258 051 179	215 267 870
Contributions from academia	1 121 000	6 000	298 542	-	-
Contributions from civil society and non-governmental organizations	2 349 000	602 000	604 718	-	-
Contributions from foundations	1 858 000	1 739 000	1 068 297	1 000 000	25 000
Contributions from international financial institutions	205 000	199 000	164 245	470 000	-
Contributions from international governmental organizations	75 246 000	33 250 000	86 829 343	67 035 953	68 000 000
Contributions from the Multi-Partner Trust Fund	13 392 000	17 001 000	14 951 824	11 000 000	11 000 000
Contributions from the public and private sectors	2 019 000	2 962 000	1 270 204	2 817 855	580 000
United Nations to United Nations	19 487 000	25 807 000	17 722 627	7 000 000	7 000 000
Grand total	**442 868 000**	**453 869 467**	**519 320 861**	**347 374 987**	**301 872 870**

9. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that to mitigate the impact of declining income, UNODC has intensified its efforts for the diversification and expansion of the donor base, including outreach to private sector partners and non-traditional donors. In addition, UNODC is expanding the cost-sharing arrangements with other United Nations entities, regional organizations and national counterparts, exploring flexible funding mechanisms and advocating for increased use of multi-year contributions and soft earmarked contributions. Furthermore, UNODC introduced measures such as programme consolidation and team realignments to ensure the continued effectiveness and quality of its programmes, in light of the reduced funding. **The Advisory Committee encourages the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime to continue to intensify its fundraising efforts, including through a range of diverse fundraising initiatives, and to report thereon in its next budget report. The Advisory Committee trusts that more**

details on the measures implemented by the Office to contain costs will be provided to the Commissions at the time of consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.

10. With regard to the balance between earmarked and unearmarked contributions, the Advisory Committee notes the level of anticipated income from unearmarked voluntary contributions amounts to $8.8 million under the general-purpose funds, compared with anticipated income from earmarked voluntary contributions amounting to $576.7 million under the special-purpose funds. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that the continuing imbalance between earmarked and unearmarked resources posed significant challenges for UNODC, particularly for its core policy and normative work. The Committee was also informed that the number of donors providing unearmarked contributions decreased sharply from 43 countries in 2003 to 18 countries in 2024. In response, UNODC continues to call upon Member States to pledge adequate unearmarked contributions and increase the share of flexible funding, including through soft-earmarked and multi-year contributions. In 2026–2027, UNODC will continue to focus on diversifying income sources, improving the predictability and sustainability of funding, and strengthening partnerships with both traditional and new donors. **The Advisory Committee notes with concern the steadily declining level of overall funding and, in particular, of the decrease in donors providing unearmarked contributions to the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime, from 43 countries in 2003 to 18 countries in 2024. While commending the fundraising efforts undertaken by the Office, the Committee trusts once again that the Office will continue its efforts to expand mobilization of flexible funding to further increase the total amount and percentage of unearmarked contributions and report thereon in its next budget report (see also E/CN.7/2023/14-E/CN.15/2023/18, para. 7)**.

Expenditure projections

11. As indicated in table 1 of the report of the Executive Director, the total initial expenditure projections for the biennium 2026–2027 amount to $783.5 million, reflecting a decrease of $130.1 million (or 14.2 per cent) compared with the expenditure of $913.6 million in the revised budget for the biennium 2024–2025. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was provided with the table below containing the latest estimated expenditures for the revised budget for 2024–2025. The Committee was also provided with the information on UNODC income and expenditure in the period 2020–2026 (see annex).

Table 2
Resource projections by object of expenditure and source of funds

	Resources (thousands of United States dollars)				*Posts*	
Fund category	*2024–2025 (initial)*	*2024–2025 (revised)*	*2024–2025 (actuals as at 30 September 2025)*	*2026–2027*	*2024–2025*	*2026–2027*
A. General-purpose						
Post	6 257.0	6 530.9	7 542.7	6 042.9	18	16
Non-post	2 953.6	2 955.5	586.5	3 112.0	-	-
Subtotal	**9 210.6**	**9 486.4**	**8 129.2**	**9 154.9**	**18**	**16**
B. Special-purpose						
Drug programme	198 224.7	225 239.3	200 843.8	235 433.4	164	162
Crime programme	536 004.2	551 727.4	508 248.7	409 242.4	587	547
Subtotal	**734 228.9**	**776 966.7**	**709 092.5**	**644 675.8**	**751**	**709**
C. Programme support cost						
Post	53 804.4	56 401.5	44 250.3	60 605.8	145	159
Non-post	14 102.8	16 612.5	15 661.3	17 037.7	-	-
Subtotal	**67 907.2**	**73 014.0**	**59 911.6**	**77 643.5**	**145**	**159**

Fund category	Resources (thousands of United States dollars)				Posts	
	2024–2025 (initial)	2024–2025 (revised)	2024–2025 (actuals as at 30 September 2025)	2026–2027	2024–2025	2026–2027
D. Regular budget						
Post	44 426.7	44 426.7	37 948.8	42 849.1	142	118
Non-post	9 675.0	9 675.0	4 591.7	9 150.6	-	-
Subtotal	**54 101.7**	**54 101.7**	**42 540.5**	**51 999.7**	**142**	**118**
Total	**865 448.4**	**913 568.8**	**819 673.8**	**783 473.9**	**1 056**	**1 002**

12. Projected expenditure in the consolidated budget for 2026–2027 by source of funds are: (a) general-purpose funds: $9.2 million, a decrease of $0.3 million, or 3.5 per cent, compared with the revised budget for 2024–2025; (b) Special-purpose funds: $644.7 million, a decrease of $132.3 million, or 17.0 per cent, compared with the revised budget for 2024–2025; (c) programme support cost funds: $ 77.6 million, an increase of $4.6 million, or 6.3 per cent, compared with the revised budget for 2024–2025; and (d) regular budget: $52.0 million, a decrease of $2.1 million, or 3.9 per cent, compared with the combined programme budgets for 2024 and 2025 (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, table 1).

13. With regard to the general-purpose funds, the projected expenditure amounts to $9.2 million for 2026–2027. The resources are proposed to achieve the following programmatic results: (a) research for policy guidance and improved programming ($3.1 million); (b) forensic and scientific services ($1.3 million); (c) criminal justice and crime prevention and organized crime ($0.7 million); (d) engagement at the highest political level, including through the New York Liaison Office ($2.0 million); and (e) strategic field interventions ($2.1 million). Two posts are proposed for abolishment, owing to the insufficient general-purpose income (ibid., paras. 57 and 58). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNODC will continue to focus on essential normative, policy and coordination functions that are central to the implementation of its mandates, as well as on leveraging partnerships within the United Nations development system and with other stakeholders to share capacities and resources in support of the delivery of its mandate.

14. With regard to the special-purpose funds, the projected expenditure amounts to $644.7 million for 2026–2027. The decrease is mainly a result of a $185.6 million (24.3 per cent) projected decrease in income for special purposes funds, to $576.7 million compared with the revised income for 2024–2025 (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, para. 51). For the drug programme fund, programme delivery is projected to grow by $11.1 million (4.9 per cent), from $225.2 million in 2024–2025 (revised budget) to $236.4 million in 2026–2027. For the crime programme fund, programme delivery is projected to decrease by $143.4 million (26.0 per cent), from $551.7 million in 2024–2025 (revised budget) to $408.3 million in 2026–2027. The decrease in voluntary contributions is foreseen to impact particularly several areas of work (ibid., para. 59).

15. With regard to the programme support cost funds, the projected expenditure amounts to $77.6 million for 2026–2027. The report indicates that although projected programme implementation decreased, it was essential to maintain the current level of programme support to sustain operations. The projected excess expenditure over the projected income of $69.6 million is proposed to be met through the exceptional use of accumulated fund balances to sustain programme implementation, preserve critical capacities and ensure the achievement of long-term programme goals (ibid., paras. 46 and 62). **The Advisory Committee notes the projected expenditure for programme support cost funds in 2026–2027 amounting to $77.6 million exceeds the anticipated income of $69.6 million. The Committee also notes that the excess expenditure is proposed to be covered through accumulated fund balances. While recognizing that abruptly reducing programme support costs in a context of marked reductions in the level of earmarked funding may have an unduly negative impact on the operations of entities predominantly funded from**

extrabudgetary resources, the Committee is of the view that more clarity needs to be provided as it relates to the existing framework for the scalability of programme support costs under a scenario of reduced funding (see also para. 26 below).

16. The report of the Executive Director indicates that under the programme support cost funds, the full allocation of the cost of field office representatives is proposed. It is indicated that this measure acknowledges the importance of the field office network in promoting more coherent and efficient integration with the United Nations system at the field level. It also responds to calls from Member States to further explore the broader use of programme support cost funds at both headquarters and in the field, as appropriate (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, para. 47).

17. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was provided with information on the allocation of administrative costs funded through programme support charges, in comparison to expenditures on programmatic activities under general-purpose funds, special-purpose funds and programme support cost funds. The Committee was informed that UNODC consistently ensures that its budget reports clearly differentiate between resources allocated to programmatic activities and those designated for administrative costs. Expenditures under special-purpose funds reflect only direct costs, encompassing substantive and operational expenses for programme delivery, programme service costs related to specific activities, and direct support costs for administrative and management services directly attributable to programme implementation. On the other hand, the indirect costs, categorized as administrative expenses, are financed through programme support cost funds and are used exclusively to recover the incremental indirect costs UNODC incurs in managing and delivering extrabudgetary activities. These include expenditures incurred by services that provide administrative, management and other support functions.

Fund balances

18. Table 3 of the report of the Executive Director provides a summary of estimates of fund balances, income and expenditure for the biennium 2026–2027. The report further indicates that the fund balances of general-purpose and programme support cost funds (unrestricted reserves) show projected amounts of $50.0 million and $99.6 million, respectively, at the beginning of the biennium 2026–2027. By comparison, in 2023, the balances of general-purpose and programme support cost funds were projected to be $22.7 million and $56.4 million, respectively, at the beginning of the biennium 2024–2025 (see E/CN.7/2023/14-E/CN.15/2023/18, para. 19).

Table 3
Summary of estimates of fund balances, income and expenditure for the biennium 2026–2027
(Millions of United States dollars)

2026–2027 Initial budget	*General-purpose funds*	*Special-purpose funds*[a]	*Programme support cost funds*
A. Funding			
Fund balance at biennium start[b]	50.0	861.9	99.6
B. Income			
Income	8.8	507.1	69.6
C. Expenditure			
Expenditure	9.2	644.7	77.6
Excess (shortfall) (B–C)	(0.4)	(137.6)	(8.0)
Fund balances at biennium end	49.6	724.3	91.6

[a] For special-purpose funds, the total income of $507.1 million is adjusted by the programme support cost income for UNODC ($69.6 million).
[b] The fund balances for general-purpose and programme support cost funds (unrestricted reserves) at the biennium start are net of the cumulative actuarial valuation of employee benefits ($41.5 million).

19. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was provided with the status of the UNODC general-purpose, special-purpose and programme support cost funds, including approved budget, current balances, received income in 2025 and expenditures against the funds in 2025 to date, as reflected in table 4.

Table 4
Summary of estimates of fund balances, income and expenditure for the biennium 2026–2027, including budgeted versus actual amount for income and expenditure in 2025
(Millions of United States dollars)

	Special-purpose		*General-purpose*		*Programme support cost*	
	Budgeted	*Actual as at 30 September 2025*	*Budgeted*	*Actual as at 30 September 2025*	*Budgeted*	*Actual as at 30 September 2025*
Fund balance as at 1 January 2025	$927.0		$50.6		$100.7	
2025 income	$307.0	$310.7	$4.2	$2.1	$36.2	$30.3
2025 expenditures	$372.1	$294.1	$4.8	$3.5	$37.2	$27.3
2026–2027 income	$507.1		$8.8		$69.6	
2026–2027 expenditures	$644.7		$9.2		$77.6	
Projected fund balance as at 31 December 2027	$724.3		$49.6		$91.6	

20. The report indicates that in accordance with the United Nations financial policies, the reserves for general-purpose funds and programme support cost funds have been set at 12 months of estimated expenditures, and the reserves for special-purpose funds were maintained at 15 per cent of estimated annual expenditure. The projected unearmarked fund balance for the biennium is $141.3 million, encompassing both general-purpose and programme support cost funds and meets the policy minimum requirement. Mitigation against the risk of anticipated decline in voluntary contributions and global fiscal constraints, along with prudent financial management, require UNODC to retain the current level of reserves (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, para. 66, table 3 and annex III).

21. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that United Nations financial policies require that adequate reserves should be maintained for trust funds and programme support cost funds to cover unforeseen expenditures or cash shortfall, final expenditures including any liquidating liabilities and/or contingent liabilities, and future corporate large-scale capital initiatives, as well as other potential costs. Considering underfunding concerns and the prevailing risks related to the implementation of large-scale voluntary funded programmes, the reserves for general-purpose funds and programme support cost funds have been set at 12 months of estimated expenditures, while the reserve for special-purpose funds were maintained at 15 per cent of estimated annual expenditure. In addition to risks related to unforeseen expenditures or cash shortfall, the reserve is also intended to mitigate risks from unforeseen circumstances such as a large-scale abrupt termination, which would result in significant shortfall in funding, necessitating liquidation of activities and settlement of all liabilities, including those related to the programme support cost funds.

22. The financial position by fund for the biennium 2026–2027 is also provided in annex III of the report of the Executive Director, as shown below.

Table 5
Financial position for the biennium 2026–2027
(Thousands of United States dollars)

	Fund of the United Nations International Drug Control Programme				*United Nation Crime Prevention and Criminal Justice Fund*[a]			
	General-purpose funds	*Special-purpose funds*	*Programme support cost funds*	*Total*	*General-purpose funds*	*Special-purpose funds*	*Programme support cost funds*	*Total*
A. Fund balances at biennium start	23 586.8	354 821.0	40 856.4	419 264.1	26 421.3	507 094.0	58 785.1	592 300.5
B. Income	5 509.1	261 364.4	17 892.8	284 766.3	3 282.3	245 744.9	51 732.2	300 759.5
C. Expenditure	5 586.5	236 356.7	22 038.1	263 981.3	3 568.4	408 319.1	55 605.4	467 492.9
Fund balances at biennium end (A+B-C)	**23 509.4**	**379 828.7**	**36 711.0**	**440 049.1**	**26 135.3**	**344 519.8**	**54 911.9**	**425 567.1**

[a] Includes the sub-fund for the United Nations Interregional Crime and Justice Research Institute.

Employee benefits liabilities

23. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that in December 2012, UNODC began funding the after-service health insurance liabilities on its extrabudgetary resources by imposing a levy on salary costs. The Committee was also informed that a separate reserve was created for these extrabudgetary funded liabilities and as at 31 December 2024 was fully funded. UNODC also maintains a separate reserve to cover the Organization's repatriation grant obligations for staff funded from extrabudgetary resources. UNODC indicates that as at 31 December 2024, these liabilities were also fully funded.

III. Staffing projections

24. Post requirements for UNODC for the bienniums 2024–2025 and 2026–2027 are provided in table 2 of the report of the Executive Director. Table 6 below provides a summary of staffing projections by fund category.

Table 6
Staffing in the biennium 2024–2025 and projection for the biennium 2026–2027

Fund category	*Posts, 2024–2025*	*Posts, 2026–2027*
General-purpose	18	16
Special-purpose	751	709
Programme support cost	145	159
Regular budget	142	118
Total	**1 056**	**1 002**

25. The report of the Executive Director indicates that the posts for 2026–2027 include those administered by UNODC and funded from special-purpose funds as of July 2025. In addition to posts funded from special-purpose funds that are included in the staffing tables as of July 2025, there were 1,029 field office local positions (service contracts) administered by the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) on behalf of UNODC. Many of those posts are of a temporary nature and their level is subject to frequent change (see E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, footnote a of table 2).

26. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the increase in posts funded through programme support cost funds in the staffing proposal for the biennium 2026–2027 reflects the increase in related funding allocated to Field Office Representative positions. Specifically, the share of programme support cost funding

for these posts increased from 85 per cent in 2024 to 100 per cent in 2025 and in the biennium 2026–2027. As a result, there is an increase of 16 posts across 16 UNODC field office locations now funded through programme support cost funds, whereas in previous bienniums, these positions were reflected under special-purpose funds. The increase in posts funded through programme support cost funds is partially offset by the proposed abolition of two General Service (Other Level) positions in Vienna, within the Division for Operations, following the functional streamlining of the Division's responsibilities. **The Advisory Committee acknowledges the efforts to reduce costs under the special-purpose funds and trusts that the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime will continue to keep expenditures under review to further identify, as appropriate, expenses that can be classified as direct costs or as programme support costs and further reduce pressure on the special-purpose funds**.

27. Regarding non-staff personnel, the report indicates that the continuous usage of local and international consultants and individual contractors comes from the nature of the technical assistance projects delivered by UNODC, with the majority of funds received from voluntary contributions which do not allow for long-term planning (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, annex V). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was provided with statistics on staff and non-staff personnel in UNODC over the last five-year period. The Advisory Committee recalls that the information does not include individual contractors which by the nature of their contractual arrangements are deemed to fall under the category of contractual services (see E/CN.7/2023/14-E/CN.15/2023/18, para. 25).

Table 7
Number of staff and non-staff personnel (service contracts administered by the United Nations Development Programme) for the period 2021–2025, at headquarters and in field offices

Category	*2021 31 December*	*2022 31 December*	*2023 31 December*	*2024 31 December*	*2025 30 September*
A. Headquarters					
Staff	427	440	437	441	426
Non-staff (service contracts)	-	-	-	-	-
Subtotal	**427**	**440**	**437**	**441**	**426**
B. Field offices					
Staff	443	444	474	499	471
Non-staff (service contracts)	1 345	1 374	1 321	1 404	1 270
Subtotal	**1 788**	**1 818**	**1 795**	**1 903**	**1 741**
Total	**2 215**	**2 258**	**2 232**	**2 344**	**2 167**

28. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNODC continues to make efforts to reduce the reliance on non-staff personnel when longer-term projects and needs are identified. The continuous usage of local and international consultants and individual contractors comes from the nature of the technical assistance projects delivered by UNODC, with the majority of funds received from voluntary contributions which do not allow for long-term planning. Flexibility is needed to respond to fast-changing project requirements and funds. Given the context of reduced income stream and insufficient and unpredictable funding, some reliance on non-staff personnel is expected to continue in 2026–2027. The Advisory Committee recalls that it was informed that UNODC was closely monitoring the duration of contracts of service contract holders and that following the implementation of the new partner personnel services agreement modality for UNODC field offices by UNDP, the use of the service contract modality would be discontinued for UNODC and other UNDP partner agencies (see E/CN.7/2023/14-E/CN.15/2023/18, para. 23). **The Advisory Committee recalls its previous recommendation that every effort be made to reduce the reliance on non-staff**

personnel. The Committee notes that the number of non-staff personnel holding service contracts in field locations changed from 1,374 as at 31 December 2022 to 1,321 as at 31 December 2023 in the 2022–2023 biennium. In the biennium 2024–2025, the number of non-staff personnel holding service contracts in field locations was 1,404 as at 31 December 2024 and had declined to 1,270 as at 30 September 2025. The Committee trusts that updated information on the usage of the service contract modality will be provided to the Commissions and be provided in future budget reports (see also E/CN.7/2023/14-E/CN.15/2023/18, para. 25).

29. The report of the Executive Director indicates that the ratio of staff to non-staff personnel was also impacted by the continuous growth of the United Nations Volunteers programme – as a result of the Office's strengthened collaboration with the United Nations Volunteers – which presents an entry-level career opportunity for young professionals (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, annex V). **The Advisory Committee once again notes the value of the United Nations Volunteers programme in providing entry level career opportunities for young professionals in the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime and trusts that further efforts will be made to ensure more equitable representation of countries (see E/CN.7/2023/14-E/CN.15/2023/18, para. 26). The Committee trusts that updated information on the increased use of United Nations Volunteers, including any relevant lessons learned, will be provided to the Commissions during consideration of the present report and in future budget reports**.

Equitable geographical representation

30. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was provided with information on the current geographical representation of the category of UNODC professional staff and above as at 30 September 2025, across all funding sources. Out of a total 493 staff, the representation is as follows: African States: 60 staff (12.2 per cent), Asia-Pacific States: 79 staff (16.0 per cent), Eastern European States: 47 staff (9.5 per cent), Latin America and the Caribbean States: 62 staff (12.6 per cent), Western European and other States: 213 staff (43.2 per cent), and the United States of America: 32 staff (6.5 per cent). **The Advisory Committee notes the imbalance of geographical representation of staff in the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime and trusts that the Office will intensify its efforts to achieve a more equitable geographical representation of Member States among its staff**.

Gender balance

31. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 30 September 2025, of the 493 staff in the professional and higher categories, 243 (or 49.3 per cent) were women and 250 (or 50.7 per cent) were men. Of the total 841 staff across all staff categories, 451 (or 53.6 per cent) were women and 390 (or 46.4 per cent) were men.

IV. Other matters

UNODC funding model

32. Paragraphs 33 to 37 of the report of the Executive Director provide information on the UNODC funding model and the changes introduced during the biennium 2014–2015. It is indicated that over 80 per cent of UNODC resources are provided through earmarked voluntary contributions, while the core funding provided through general-purpose funds contributions constitutes only 1 per cent of funding. It is also indicated that the continuing imbalance between earmarked and unearmarked resources poses significant challenges for UNODC. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that since the biennium 2014–2015, UNODC has progressively adjusted its funding model to enhance financial sustainability. A system of full cost recovery was introduced to ensure that administrative costs at field offices

related to extrabudgetary activities are adequately covered. Additionally, the Office streamlined its global programmes to achieve economies of scale and improve delivery at the field level. The Committee was also informed that in recent bienniums, UNODC has further enhanced its funding model through a corporate fundraising strategy aimed at diversifying its donor base and promoting soft-earmarked and core contributions. Member States are being encouraged to increase general-purpose funding and provide more flexible voluntary contributions.

33. The Advisory Committee was also informed that in the biennium 2026–2027, UNODC will maintain its focus on broadening income sources, enhancing financial predictability and sustainability and strengthening partnerships with both traditional and emerging donors. UNODC indicates that in recent bienniums, it further refined its funding model through a corporate fundraising plan aimed at diversifying its donor base and encouraging soft-earmarked and core contributions. Member States are being encouraged to increase their general-purpose funding and to provide more flexible voluntary contributions. Furthermore, UNODC is, in parallel, assessing its field office footprint and cost structure to optimize resource utilization, encourage cost-sharing with host countries and regional organizations and better align field operations with programme delivery requirements (see para. 36 below).

United Nations system-wide coordination

34. Paragraphs 38 to 40 of the report of the Executive Director indicate the engagement by UNODC with the Secretariat-wide initiative of United Nations development system reform in terms of the implementation of the United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework. It is indicated that UNODC contributes to the Framework through its efforts on promoting peace, justice and strong institutions essential for achieving sustainable development. It is indicated that as of July 2025, UNODC was a member of 111 of the 137 United Nations country teams operating globally. Between 2019 and 2024, UNODC contributed to 119 cooperation frameworks, including 44 newly developed in 2024. The Office is also actively engaged in regional reform efforts across all five regions through the respective regional collaborative platforms. Notably, in partnership with 11 other United Nations entities, UNODC established the United Nations Information Laboratory on Crime and Corruption for Latin America and the Caribbean. Furthermore, since 2019, UNODC has participated in over 95 projects and joint programmes funded through a diverse range of multi-partner trust funds, a funding modality promoted under the United Nations development system reform agenda. **The Advisory Committee trusts that the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime will continue its engagement with the resident coordinator system and United Nations country teams in support of Member States, particularly those with vulnerable economies or facing significant challenges, on its mandated activities in crime prevention, criminal justice, corruption mitigation and drug control. The Committee emphasizes the importance of inter-agency cooperation and coordination in leveraging synergies and avoiding duplication of efforts, and trusts that information on efficiencies achieved by the Office by its engagement in the United Nations system efficiency agenda will be provided to the Commissions at the time of consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission**.

Regional and field presence

35. The report of the Executive Director indicates that as of July 2025, UNODC maintained a presence in 167 countries and territories, including a physical presence in 103 countries and territories and a non-physical presence in 64. The physical presence in 103 countries and territories comprises 10 regional offices, 7 country offices and 86 programme offices. UNODC also has two liaison offices, in Brussels and New York (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, paras. 39 and 55). Upon request, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNODC is reassessing its field footprint to enhance strategic alignment and operational efficiency. Best practices and lessons

learned across various administrative areas, including air ticket compliance, asset management and financial procedures, have been identified, documented and disseminated across field offices. Additionally, UNODC has formalized several key roles, including Deputy Representatives and Heads of Offices, and developed standardized guidance for large, medium and small field office configurations aimed at enhancing coherence within and across offices in similar regions. Furthermore, UNODC has in recent years undertaken the consolidation of its regional hubs. For instance, the Regional Office for the Andean Region and the Southern Cone has been integrated with the offices in Bolivia (Plurinational State of) and Peru, while the Regional Office for Central Asia has consolidated offices in Afghanistan, Iran (Islamic Republic of) and Pakistan. UNODC will continue to pursue further rationalization of its field presence where appropriate.

36. **The Advisory Committee notes that the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime is reassessing its field footprint to enhance strategic alignment and operational efficiency and trusts that more detailed and updated information on the review of the field footprint, including its impact on allocation of resources and implementation of programmes in its regional, country and programme offices, as well as any efficiencies achieved, will be provided to the Commissions. The Committee reiterates the continued need for regional and country presence in support of least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States (see E/CN.7/2023/14-E/CN.15/2023/18, para. 43). Furthermore, the Committee trusts that more detailed information on the consolidation of regional hubs, including the criteria used and selection of locations, will be provided to the Commissions at the time of consideration of this report, including in view of the intended regional reset announced by the Secretary-General in his report on the third workstream of the UN80 Initiative (A/80/392). The Committee also trusts that the Office will draw upon lessons learned and best practices from other United Nations entities that have already undergone optimization initiatives**.

37. The Advisory Committee recalls that, as regards support to field offices, the main administrative support functions are provided by the Division for Management of United Nations Office at Vienna/UNODC from Vienna to all field office locations. The Committee also recalls that some administrative functions have been decentralized in field offices in cases where that would not result in duplicative administrative structures. **The Advisory Committee trusts that an update on the initiatives and progress undertaken by the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime in support of field offices will be provided to the Commissions and included in the next budget report (see also E/CN.7/2023/14-E/CN.15/2023/18, para. 44)**.

UN80 Initiative

38. The report of the Executive Director indicates that UNODC participated in the clusters on peace and security, development, and training and research of the UN80 Initiative. The report also indicates that the UNODC consolidated budget reflects the preliminary proposals that will be included in the revised estimates for the 2026 budget (E/CN.7/2025/14-E/CN.15/2025/17, paras. 41–43). Regular budget resources are anticipated at $52.0 million, on the assumption that the level proposed for 2026, taking into account the revised estimates in line with the UN80 Initiative, will be maintained in 2027, including adjustments for non-recurrent activities (ibid., para. 44). **The Advisory Committee trusts that the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime will continue to seek out opportunities to improve effectiveness and efficiency and considers that the UN80 Initiative offers a meaningful opportunity towards that end. The Advisory Committee also trusts that United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime, in collaboration with the Office of Counter-Terrorism, will continue to take measures to avoid duplications and overlap between the Offices and with other United Nations entities, as well as strengthen coordination across the United Nations system, in accordance with paragraphs 41 and 56 of General**

Assembly resolution 79/257. The Committee further trusts that updated information, including any efficiencies achieved, will be provided to the Commissions during consideration of this report and in future budget reports.

Implementation of the recommendations of the Advisory Committee and other legislative bodies

39. The report of the Executive Director includes, in its annex V, information on the follow-up actions taken to implement relevant recommendations of the Advisory Committee and of the Board of Auditors. **The Advisory Committee trusts that all outstanding recommendations will be implemented in a timely manner.**

Annex

UNODC income and expenditure, 2020–2026

A. Income, 2020–2026

(United States dollars)

Income	*2020*	*2021*	*2022*	*2023*	*2024*	*2025 (final)*	*2025 (as at 30 September)*	*2026 (initial)*
General-purpose	4 837 082	4 985 612	4 619 145	3 621 344	3 953 425	4 183 812	2 124 086	4 395 735
Special-purpose	312 824 880	341 381 887	348 231 410	396 115 497	434 909 508	343 191 175	310 733 291	297 477 135
Programme support cost	23 615 280	29 865 832	37 422 929	42 235 386	44 936 897	40 187 498	30 280 795	36 212 595
Regular budget	22 525 039	23 428 932	22 866 205	23 539 145	25 195 329	22 836 900	22 836 900	26 273 697
Total	**363 802 281**	**399 662 263**	**413 139 689**	**465 511 373**	**508 995 160**	**410 399 385**	**365 975 072**	**364 359 162**

B. Expenditure, 2020–2026

(United States dollars)

Expenditure	*2020*	*2021*	*2022*	*2023*	*2024*	*2025 (final)*	*2025 (as at 30 September)*	*2026 (initial)*
General-purpose	3 438 696	4 396 094	3 777 858	4 252 546	4 588 629	4 803 350	3 540 526	4 698 800
Special-purpose	260 824 771	297 791 793	339 508 146	383 871 085	414 976 555	372 106 461	294 115 860	335 301 805
Programme support cost	24 451 473	23 166 580	23 187 684	31 613 164	32 567 035	37 213 934	27 344 560	38 614 900
Regular budget	22 525 039	23 428 932	22 866 205	23 539 145	25 195 329	29 030 500	17 345 176	26 273 697
Total	**311 239 979**	**348 783 399**	**389 339 893**	**443 275 940**	**477 327 548**	**443 154 245**	**342 346 122**	**404 889 202**